

TAB 17



Board of Education Report

File #: Res-017-23/24, Version: 1

Mr. Schmerelson - Remembering and Honoring the Significance of Lunar New Year (Res-017-23/24) (For Action January 23, 2024)

Whereas, California Assembly Bill 2596, codified in law in the Code of Civil Procedure in September 2022, recognizes the Lunar New Year, as the date corresponding with the second new moon following the winter solstice, or the third new moon following the winter solstice should an intercalary month intervene, as a state holiday;

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District has a significant Asian American student population;

Whereas, The Lunar New Year is one of the most important holidays celebrated across Asian countries as well as the Asian diaspora;

Whereas, The Lunar New year is one of the most important holidays in China, Vietnam, South Korea, and other Asian countries, and one of the most widely celebrated among Asian Americans;

Whereas, The Lunar New Year is based on the lunar calendar and marks the arrival of spring;

Whereas, The Lunar New Year celebrates a chance to leave behind the troubles of the past year and invites prosperity and good luck moving forward;

Whereas, The state has already recognized this day as a state holiday acknowledges the diversity and cultural significance Asian Americans bring to California and demonstrates an understanding of the importance of wanting to see one's own experience reflected in state holidays;

Whereas, Recognition by the state has much significance to a community that has traditionally and historically been overlooked;

Whereas, The state's commemoration of Lunar New Year was meaningful, especially amid the wave of hatred and violence toward Asian Americans that has escalated since the pandemic began;

Whereas, The District has been at the forefront of encouraging and promoting a curriculum relating to diversity and equity in order to empower future generations;

Whereas, The concern for human rights is a major element in the History-Social Science Framework for California Public Schools, Kindergarten through 12th grade;

Whereas, The District is committed to confronting difficult subjects, including the Asian American Pacific Islander Hate, in inclusive ways that ensure all students are respected and has strong nondiscrimination and anti-bullying policies to that end; and

Whereas, The Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District has adopted other diverse cultural holidays recognized by our families, in school calendars set to go into effect in the 2022-2023 school year; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District hereby commemorates the date corresponding with the second new moon following the winter solstice, or the third new moon following the winter solstice should an intercalary month intervene, as the “Lunar New year”; and, be it finally

Resolved, That the Board encourages all schools to incorporate lessons on the Lunar New Year in instruction, and that relevant and appropriate instructional resources be made available to all P-12 educators to utilize in schools to ensure that the Asian American Pacific Islander history and culture are appropriately and meaningfully shared with students, staff, and families.